

Christians destroy Irminsul, the world tree

The destruction of Irminsul by Charlemagne (1882) by Heinrich Leutemann. In the 770s, a holy wood at Eresburg, also sacred to the Saxons, was taken in battle by Charlemagne. The victorious Christian forces destroyed the holy Irminsul, a tall pillar in the wood representing the world tree Yggdrasil. Surviving Saxon boys were carried off to be indoctrinated and trained as missionaries.